PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #50 · ANXIETY

“I can’t relax until I am sure everything is safe.”

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Where it often comes from

Safety is good. Anxiety turns it into a condition that can never be met. There is always one more lock, one more test, one more reassurance, one more corner of the future that has not been inspected. People who lived with real unpredictability, or who love people they cannot fully protect, are especially vulnerable to this rule. The lie says rest is allowed only after certainty. Certainty about everything never arrives, so rest never arrives either.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist sleeps in peace because the Lord, not a completed safety review, makes him dwell in safety. The Protector of Israel does not slumber, which means you may. God keeps in peace the mind that trusts Him. Paul says to be anxious for nothing and to pray, and the peace of God will guard the heart. Jesus refuses to let tomorrow’s unfinished business steal today. You will not reach a moment when every risk is gone. Scripture offers peace before that impossible moment.

> *“I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety”* (Psalm 4:8).

Also see

> “He will not allow your foot to slip; your Protector will not slumber. Behold, the Protector of Israel will neither slumber nor sleep” (Psalm 121:3–4).

> “You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You” (Isaiah 26:3).

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:6–7).

> “Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own” (Matthew 6:34).

Common self-statements

- I will relax when I know everyone is safe.
- There is always one more thing to check.
- Resting now would be selfish or careless.
- If I feel any doubt, I am not allowed to stop.
- Other people can live with risk. I cannot.
- God wants me to be certain before I am peaceful.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Either everything is safe or I cannot rest at all.
- Fortune telling: Believing that the unchecked item is the one that will cause harm.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unfinished and concluding that rest is forbidden.
- Moving the goalposts: Each time one fear is settled, requiring a new one to be settled before peace is allowed.

Challenging questions

- What would “sure enough” be, and have I ever reached it?
- Which of my checks actually increase safety, and which only feed the feeling?
- What am I refusing to leave in God’s hands?
- If I waited for certainty, would I ever sleep?
- What does Psalm 4:8 say is the reason for peace?
- What is one safety behavior I can lay down tonight?

Truth summary

> I will never be sure of every danger. I can rest before I have certainty, because God is my safety.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

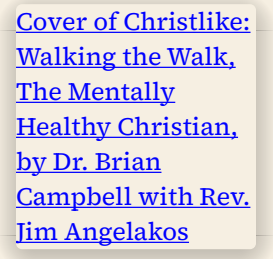
- Anxiety/Worry
- Peace
- Trust
- Sleep Problems
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Prayer
- Thinking, Healthy

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from “The Mentally Healthy Christian” (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Our God — Chris Tomlin
God is your safety. Your certainty is not.

Amen — Steven Curtis Chapman
You can rest in what Christ has done instead of in a finished checklist.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
You are held before every question is answered.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
Christ invites you to come and rest, not to finish securing the world first.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't relax until I am sure everything is safe."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't relax until I am sure everything is safe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What would "sure enough" be, and have I ever reached it?
- ☐ Which of my checks actually increase safety, and which only feed the feeling?
- ☐ What am I refusing to leave in God's hands?
- ☐ If I waited for certainty, would I ever sleep?
- ☐ What does Psalm 4:8 say is the reason for peace?
- ☐ What is one safety behavior I can lay down tonight?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I will never be sure of every danger. I can rest before I have certainty, because God is my safety.
- ☐ Complete certainty is not available, and I can still rest.
- ☐ God makes me dwell in safety. My checklist does not.
- ☐ I can be responsible and then stop.
- ☐ Peace is a gift to receive, not a prize for finishing every fear.
- ☐ One more check will not create the certainty I am chasing.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 4:8
  "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety."
- ☐ Psalm 121:3–4
  "He will not allow your foot to slip; your Protector will not slumber. Behold, the Protector of Israel will neither slumber nor sleep."
- ☐ Isaiah 26:3
  "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When rest felt illegal: Each day, write down one moment when you could not relax until everything felt certain. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 4:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can lie down in peace, because the Lord makes me dwell in safety.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Peace" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Stop at a set number of checks. Decide the reasonable checks in advance. When they are done, do not add one more.
- [ ] Rest on purpose for twenty minutes while one question is still unanswered, if no one is in immediate danger. Write whether harm arrived.
- [ ] Read Psalm 4:8 at bedtime and then put the phone away from the worries.
- [ ] Name what only God can secure. Write one fear you cannot fully control, and pray it instead of checking it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't relax until I am sure everything is safe.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A rest I took before I felt certain
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't relax until I am sure everything is safe~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have made certainty the door to rest, and the door never opens. You are the One who makes me dwell in safety. Teach me to lie down before every question is answered. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.